G A P

Editing, sound and the information a frame withholds



05:38 · The reverse angle brings both characters into a shared frame.

05:36:16 - movement becomes meaning

A cut during Gao Chen’s rise changes both the camera angle and the way the two characters occupy the frame. It is the clearest example in this case study of editing doing narrative work.

THE FILM	MY CONTRIBUTION	THIS CASE STUDY
2022 · short fiction	Writing and directing	Timecoded visual and sound cases
9:14 including credits	Editing, colour, sound post	Technical delivery checks

Original post-production completed in DaVinci Resolve. All film images shown here come from the final master; the black bars are removed for presentation, with no additional colour grade.

Portfolio | **Analysis reel** | **Full film**

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01 · CONTEXT

The filmmaker and the film

Bian Luotao

Based in Jiaxing, China. I wrote and directed *G A P*, then edited, graded and completed its sound post in DaVinci Resolve. I currently work in textile export and am seeking part-time remote video-evaluation work in the evenings and at weekends (UTC+8).

BACKGROUND	DETAIL
Post-production	DaVinci Resolve Edit, Color and Fairlight; Fusion at a basic level.
Education	University of Essex, UK (Sep 2024-Sep 2025): film-related undergraduate study; no degree awarded. Kaplan International College London (2023-2024): Foundation Certificate for Business, Law and Social Sciences; completed. High school, China: completed.
Language	Chinese: native. English: previous IELTS overall score of 6.0.

A story about what people conceal

The film follows a young worker, Wang Liang, his boyfriend Gao Chen and his father, a delivery rider. Workplace humiliation and a strained family relationship converge around a confrontation in a noodle shop. The visual approach often keeps a face, reaction or source of pressure outside the frame.



05:58 · Frosted glass and the seated manager establish a visible hierarchy.

Contribution and evidence

My signed screenplay drafts document the writing, and the end credits list me as director. I did the editing, colour grading and sound post myself; these roles are not listed individually in the end credits. Cinematography, location sound and lighting belong to the credited crew.

Two ways to reveal a relationship

01 A cut that changes the relationship



05:33 · One character is partly hidden.



05:38 · Both share the reverse angle.

Observation · 05:36:16. The cut lands as Gao Chen rises. The following angle shows the two from behind, with his hand on Wang Liang's back.

Reading. Movement carries attention across the cut while the new framing makes physical support visible. The interpretation comes from the change in bodies and space; it does not require a claim about the unseen editing process.

Trade-off. Before the cut, Gao Chen is partly obscured, so some of his reactions are difficult to see.

02 One doorway, two occupants



03:18 · Wang Liang in the doorway.



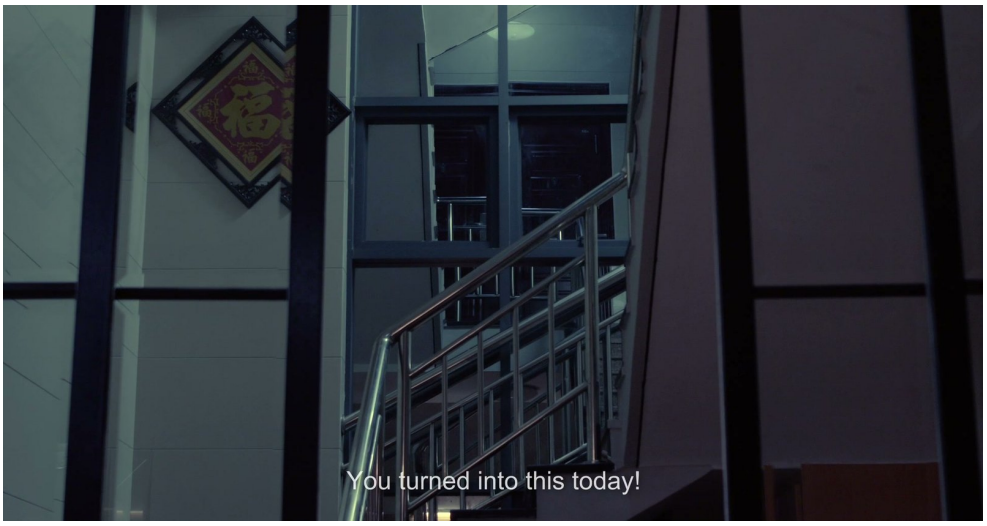
03:31 · His father occupies the frame.

Observation · 03:01-03:32. A static doorway composition passes from son to father without a cut between their appearances.

Reading. Holding the frame invites comparison between the two people. The empty interval can convey hesitation, while the dark face remains a visibility concern.

Sound carries conflict beyond the frame

03 The stairwell holds; the pressure continues



03:48:18 to 04:12:10 · Source passage in the stairwell scene (24 fps).

Observation. The scene moves from the father on the stairs to a held view of the stairwell. After he leaves the view, off-screen one-sided reprimands, impacts and pauses continue.

Reading. Speech and its interruptions carry the confrontation beyond the frame. A continuous excerpt preserves that progression; isolated stills would remove the evidence. The specific sources of the impacts are not established.

04 Staying with the person under pressure



06:33 · Attention stays with Wang Liang.



06:49 · A hand later enters the shared frame.

Observation · 06:30-06:48. Off-screen provocation accompanies Wang Liang looking down and eating. The dialogue changes how we read his silence and small actions; the camera does not need to cut to every speaker.

Limit. Later, parts of the confrontation become visible and others move outside the frame. Sound sustaining conflict does not make every physical action legible.

Where information becomes hard to read

05 The discovery remains in a soft background



02:53 · Once the shot settles on the father, the background interaction stays soft.

Observation · approximately 02:48-02:54. Focus favours the father's profile; the background interaction does not become comparably clear in the checked passage.

Risk. A first-time viewer may struggle to identify exactly what he notices. Context and the following scene may still supply that information; softness alone does not prove narrative failure.

Production option. If direct recognition is essential, a focus pull or a brief point-of-view insert would give more evidence. A finished master cannot recover detail that was never recorded.

06 Rotation competes with the rescue action



08:06 · The helmet remains near a rotating view.



08:14 · A stable view shows the aftermath.

Observation · 08:03-08:12. Rotation and fragments of bodies make the protective action difficult to identify in the checked frames. The image does not establish how the camera was mounted.

With this master: shorten the rotation and reach the aftermath earlier. **For a reshoot:** add a stable view of the decisive action and the son's response. The first option changes pacing; it cannot supply missing coverage.

A response left unresolved

07 A pause is not proof of reconciliation



08:23 · A brief line accompanies the father's response near the doorway.

Observation · 08:20-08:44. Brief speech and pauses accompany the two young men supporting each other and the father lingering near the doorway before leaving.

Reading. The ending leaves his response unresolved. His pause and departure do not establish full acceptance or reconciliation. Exact wording and speaker attribution for the key line remain unconfirmed; this analysis does not replace the original subtitles.

Separate the final image from its production causes

The doorway face has limited separation from the surrounding shadows; the pick-up-window passage is visibly warmer. The master cannot separate the effects of lighting, camera settings and colour grading. Whole-frame luma and colour distributions describe sampled image content, not the exposure of a face or a specific grading operation.

Two audio streams, not confirmed stereo

The master contains two separate 48 kHz mono audio streams. A full-length sample scan found non-zero signal in the second around 02:08 and 02:54. The selected staircase, restaurant and ending passages use the first stream; the second is digitally silent in those intervals. Its intended routing remains unconfirmed.

Signal checks locate activity and level limits. They do not establish a sound source, audible distortion or playback quality on a physical device. The method on page 8 states the completed scope.

Subtitle QA: precise, local corrections

Burned-in text is part of the final image. Selected examples below separate visible English errors from translation questions that require the spoken Chinese.

TIME	VISIBLE TEXT	PROPOSED CORRECTION / SCOPE
01:03	Bloodyhell! How come they are here so early!	“Bloody hell!” needs a space. Choice of dialect is a localisation decision, not automatically an error.
03:13	How could you be with a guy.	Use a question mark: “How could you be with a guy?”
05:22	I thought everything will be fine if we mind ous own business.	“I thought we’d be fine if we minded our own business.” Corrects spelling and tense sequence.
06:00	How many times you were late?	“How many times were you late?” fixes question word order. “How many times have you been late?” is a context-dependent alternative for a period extending to the present.

Meaning needs the original dialogue



08:23 · “Mom always knows!” appears in the final image.

The burned-in English supports a reading that the mother knows. The exact Chinese wording and speaker remain unconfirmed in this case study. A final translation would require the creator to confirm the line against the recording. The original subtitles are preserved.

Reading speed and coverage

A useful workflow is to log each subtitle’s first and last visible frames, count characters consistently, flag fast cards, then read them during normal playback. A platform-specific threshold is a screening aid, not a universal quality rule. Complete dialogue coverage and translation accuracy are not claimed here.

From film observation to video evaluation

Evidence, impact and response

FIELD	EXAMPLE
Clip / dimension	G A P, 07:59-08:12 · action legibility
Observed evidence	Movement and obstruction make parts of the confrontation difficult to reconstruct. Sound maintains conflict but does not establish every physical action.
Impact / confidence	Potential loss of story information. The checked frames and analysis support a legibility risk, not a verified account of who initiates each action.
Style / defect distinction	Rotation is visible. Whether it is intended and whether it serves the story are separate questions.
Response	Shorten the rotation using the master; add stable coverage only in a reshoot.

Applying the approach to video evaluation

Check requested action, identity and object continuity, camera movement, timing, image legibility and on-screen text separately. Name the visible evidence and its time range. Distinguish a stylistic choice from a failure to provide the requested information, and use the employer's rubric before assigning a numerical score.

Method and authorship

I wrote and directed the film with a credited crew, and did its original editing, colour grade and sound post myself. This case study is a later presentation of selected moments from that work.

Source timings, selected signal properties and visible actions were cross-checked. I listened on headphones to every excerpt in the reel and the corresponding passages of the original film, and I agree with the observations presented here. Uncertain dialogue and sound-source identifications are not treated as established facts. Frame-by-frame lip-sync inspection and complete subtitle-to-dialogue verification were not part of this review.

I no longer have the original camera media, Resolve project or separate production audio. All examples come from the final master. Timecodes count from the first frame of the film; frame-qualified timecodes use 24 fps. The reel labels selected excerpts and does not invent alternative coverage or before/after processing.

Watch the work

Portfolio | **Analysis reel** | **Full film**

https://luotaobian.github.io/gap-portfolio/

Team credits: producer Guo Qiancheng; cinematography Yu Yin; location sound Lai Chengxi; lighting Meng Wei. I do not claim these crew roles.

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